MSc Artificial Intelligence

Student Handbook

September 2025

School of Electronics, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

1. Introduction

This handbook provides information to students regarding the MSc Artificial Intelligence. It should be referred to as necessary throughout the year.

2. Key Contacts and School Information

Programme Director	Dr Barry Devereux ECIT 02.024/10. Malone Road Room 1G.004 Email: b.devereux@qub.ac.uk General matters regarding the MSc Course
Programme Secretary	Martin Devenney (Ashby Building 07.014) Tel: 9097 5436 Email: pgt-admin-eeecs@qub.ac.uk (Monday, Tuesday, Wednesday am) Briege Jackson (Wednesday pm, Thursday, Friday) (Ashby Building 07.014) Tel: 9097 5436 Email: pgt-admin-eeecs@qub.ac.uk Anna Kernohan (Wednesday pm, Thursday, Friday) (Ashby Building 07.014) Tel: 9097 5436 Email: pgt-admin-eeecs@qub.ac.uk
Advisor of Studies	Dr Reza Rafiee (Computer Science Building Room 02.009) Tel: 028 9097 4372 Email: g.rafiee@qub.ac.uk General matters regarding the MSc Course, e.g. regulations regarding progression, etc
Lecturers	All matters concerning individual modules, coursework, labs, assessment, etc. should be directed to the appropriate module owner:

ECS8050	Foundations of AI Dr Lu Bai l.bai@qub.ac.uk
ECS8051	Machine Learning Prof Hui Wang h.wang@qub.ac.uk
ECS8052	Knowledge Engineering Prof Iain Styles i.styles@qub.ac.uk
ECS8053	Computer Vision Dr Yang Hua y.hua@qub.ac.uk
ECS8054	Natural Language Processing Dr Barry Devereux b.devereux@qub.ac.uk
ECS8055	AI for Health Dr Reza Rafiee g.rafiee@qub.ac.uk
ECS8056	MSC AI Research Project Dr Mohammed Hasanuzzaman m.hasanuzzaman@qub.ac.uk

Project Supervisors	Once your project begins, you should direct enquiries to your project supervisor. Contact details at: http://www.qub.ac.uk/schools/eeecs/Connect/Staff/
Student Finance *	All matter relating to fees, etc. are processed by Student Finance, located in the Student Guidance Centre. Tel: 028 9097 2767 Email: studentfinance@qub.ac.uk
Immigration Support Service *	All matters regarding visa, etc. Located in One Elmwood. immigration@qub.ac.uk Tel: 028 9097 3820 Web: http://www.qub.ac.uk/sites/iss/

* Note that staff in the School cannot offer advice on matters relating to student finance or visa issues. Please contact Student Finance or the Immigration Support Service who deal with such issues.

3. Semester Dates

University Semester dates for academic year 2025-26 can be found at:
Semester dates | About | Queen's University Belfast (qub.ac.uk)

4. Student Charter

The University's Student Charter sets out how the University will work in partnership with you to support your learning and help you to realise your ambitions, as well as the standards of behaviour and personal responsibility that we expect from our students. Students should be aware of their duties and responsibilities towards fellow students, University staff, visitors to the University and the local community. The Student Charter can be found at:

https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/StudentCharter/.

5. General Regulations

By enrolling at Queen's University Belfast, you undertake to abide by all of our regulations, policies and procedures so it is important that you familiarise yourself with them.

The University's General Regulations contain important information about the rules governing progression, assessment, degree classification and postgraduate awards on all programmes. They assure the University's academic standards and ensure all students are treated consistently and equitably. They are also part of the formal contract between you and the University. The University's General Regulations can be found at:

http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/

Students are expected to treat other people equally and with respect, and to behave responsibly, both on and off campus, and on social media and other forms of communication. Students should be aware of the impact of their behaviour on the University's reputation.

Breaches of University regulations may be dealt with under:

(i) Conduct Regulations
https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/ConductRegulations/ or, where appropriate

(ii) Fitness to Practise Procedure
https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/Procedures/FitnesstoPractiseProcedure/

If you have any problems understanding any of these regulations, policies and procedures, or if you have any questions, it is important that you discuss them with your Advisor of Studies or Advice SU in the Students' Union.

6. Programme Information

This programme aims to:

- Develop the next generation of thought/industry leaders & address the shortage of AI professionals globally
- Provide graduates with a comprehensive understanding of the AI challenges facing industry & society
- Equip graduates with the knowledge and skills necessary to address those challenges, and the foundation to adapt to the evolving technological and industrial landscapes.

7. Changes to Programmes

Queen's is committed to keeping our programmes up to date to ensure that our students receive a current and engaging educational experience within an innovative learning and assessment environment. This commitment means that changes to programmes can occur as part of our normal academic cycle of programme development and review. These changes, which we believe will enhance your degree, are based on many factors, including ensuring each programme remains contemporary and viable; improving the quality of educational services; responding to student and/or external feedback; or meeting the requirements of an accrediting body.

The University will consult with current students when considering material changes to a programme, as defined by the Competition and Markets Authority (CMA). This consultation will be managed through Student Voice Committees and student representatives on School and/or Faculty Education Committees. In all cases where a material change to a programme is made, we will communicate to students affected by the change at the earliest possible opportunity. In most cases, this will be in the academic year before the change happens.

The range and content of optional modules may change over time. Your programme information sets out the optional modules currently available for the programme, but the options listed may not run in any given year. Delivery of optional modules may depend on student demand, staff availability and developments in the subject.

8. Teaching and Learning

Canvas is the University-wide Virtual Learning Environment (VLE) for students at Queen's which is used to support learning and teaching activities. The login to Canvas is at https://canvas.qub.ac.uk

The self-paced "Canvas Student Orientation Course" online course provides key information to help students get started with Canvas. Students can familiarise themselves with the Key Topics in the online course before beginning to use Canvas. Information on the Student App is also contained in the course.

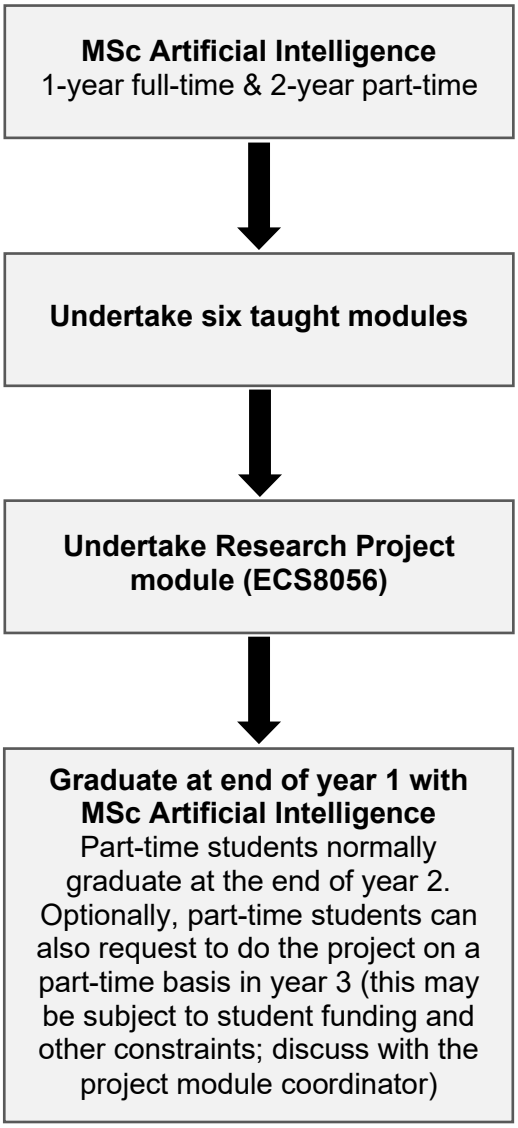
- Link to Canvas Student Orientation Course: http://go.qub.ac.uk/StudentCanvasCourse
- Canvas Orientation Video: http://go.qub.ac.uk/CanvasOrientation

The Digital Learning@Queen's site contains key guidance, Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs), and Support information relevant to students at Queen's http://go.qub.ac.uk/CanvasForStudents

Canvas Tier 1 Support is available 24x7x365 for all students. The team supports technical queries as well as providing advice on how Canvas can be used, and the 'how do I' type questions. The Support Team can be reached via the 'Help' menu in Canvas. There are a number of contact methods available including https://blogs.qub.ac.uk/digitallearning/need-help/

8.1 Course Structure

All students are required to study six taught modules and to complete an individual research project.Two pathways are available, which are described in the diagram below:



8.2 Modules

The following taught modules must be taken:

ECS8050	Foundations in AI
ECS8051	Machine Learning
ECS8052	Knowledge Engineering
ECS8053	Computer Vision
ECS8054	Natural Language Processing
ECS8055	AI for Health
ECS8056	MSc AI Project

High-level module descriptions are summarised below for convenience only. A record of complete information for each module is accessible via QSIS.

ECS8050 Foundations in AI

This module will cover the fundamental mathematics underlying AI including probability and statistics, calculus, algebra and optimisation. It will provide you with a sound understanding of the fundamentals; develop the ability to utilise them to understand and explain various AI techniques, and the ability to identify the most suitable modelling, optimisation, factorisation, and transformation approach for a given problem.

ECS8051 Machine Learning

This module will cover different types of machine learning and various algorithms of each type. It will provide you with a systematic understanding of machine learning as a subject area, develop your ability to identify problems that can be solved using machine learning methods, to apply suitable machine learning algorithms and software packages to solve real-world problems, to evaluate and compare the performance of machine learning methods for a given problem, and to present and discuss the results of machine learning methods and propose appropriate improvements to methods.

ECS8052 Knowledge Engineering

This module will cover classical and modern knowledge engineering techniques including logic, ontology, knowledge graph, and uncertainty reasoning. It will provide you with a systematic understanding of knowledge, principles and procedures of knowledge engineering, develop your ability to utilise suitable knowledge-based methods to solve real-world problems, and ability to evaluate and compare the performance of knowledge-based solutions for a given problem.

ECS8053 Computer Vision

This module will cover deep neural networks (DNNs) and modern approaches to computer vision including DNN models for various computer vision tasks and current topics of computer vision. It will develop the ability to utilise DNN models to solve real-world computer vision challenges, the ability to obtain image/video data from recognised repositories, the ability to utilise existing libraries and packages for implementing appropriate DNN models for a given computer vision task.

ECS8054 Natural Language Processing

This module will mainly cover modern approaches to natural language processing (NLP), including various deep neural networks (DNNs) for NLP, current topics of NLP. It will develop the ability to utilise DNN models to solve real-world NLP challenges, the ability to obtain language data from recognised repositories, the ability to utilise existing libraries and packages for developing NLP models, and an awareness of current developments, methods

and applications of NLP.

ECS8055 AI for Health

This module will serve as a case study of AI applications. It will cover contemporary digital health topics such as precision medicine, diagnostics, medical imaging and drug discovery. It will develop the ability to utilise AI principles and techniques to solve some health challenges, the ability to obtain relevant data from recognised repositories, the ability to utilise existing libraries and packages for analysing and visualising health data, and the transferable skills to apply AI to solve practical challenges.

ECS8056 MSc AI Project

A themed project is a research project in an approved theme. Each theme may run for a number of years, which is related to a strong area of research in the School. The topic of each project will usually be drawn from the following thematic areas of artificial intelligence covered by the Programme: machine learning (e.g., detection learning), knowledge engineering (e.g., clinical decision support systems, AI for education), computer vision (e.g., video search), natural language processing (e.g., question answering), and AI for health (e.g., medical image processing, biomarker discovery). Subject to approval by the Programme Director, other themes not covered by the Programme may be included. These additional themes may be sponsored by a third party (e.g., a company) and sponsorship may be in the form of paying for the Levelling-Up Programme at the start of the Project. In some cases, a project may have a topic outside these thematic areas.

8.3 Lectures and Labs

The university calendar is divided into teaching semesters and each semester is typically 13 weeks long. The MSc Artificial Intelligence has a 21 module per day" teaching mode and each module is taught over 10 weeks (excluding reading weeks, consolidation weeks and university closures).

The face-to-face teaching of each module consists of immersive days of Lectures & Labs normally delivered between 9am and 5pm and covers the core content of the module. Each module owner will provide you the particular details and schedule of teaching delivery.

At the start of and during each module, module owners will supply students with reading and revision materials. It is essential that you complete this independent study.

The breakdown of assessments per module will be explained during the first lecture of each module.

8.4 Timetable

A timetable for the six taught modules can be found in the Appendix 1. This may be subject to revision and module owners will communicate any changes on Canvas.

8.5 Artificial Intelligence Teaching Facilities

In almost all cases the MSc Artificial Intelligence will be delivered on campus. However, in a small number of cases, some lectures / modules may be delivered online via MS Teams. When this happens students will be informed. Labs and lectures will generally be delivered in person.

8.6 Attendance

The format of this MSc offers significant freedom for students to manage their own studies. It is therefore essential that you not only attend scheduled classes, but also carry out independent study and revision.

During timetabled periods for completion of coursework, it is essential that you carefully manage the work required for each module. Some events, such as CV workshops, may be scheduled on or near the deadline day for coursework submissions. You should plan your work, so you have time to both submit your coursework and attend such events.

8.7 Employability & Professional Skills Training

Training in employability and professional skills is provided as an integral part of the MSc to further enhance students' employability after graduation.

This training includes an Applications Workshop on CVs. Students are encouraged to attend.

Dates and further information will be confirmed in advance of the training sessions.

9. Assessment and Feedback

The MSc programme is subject to QUB Regulations. QUB regulations should be consulted as the primary source of such information. The regulations are partly restated here for convenience only.

Regulations, as published at the following link, take precedence in all cases:

https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/Academic/StudyRegulations/StudyRegulationsforPostgraduateTaughtProgrammes/

A range of assessment instruments can be used, which may include laboratory-based assignments, group and individual projects, written coursework, practical exams and unseen written exams. Students will be informed of any compulsory elements within the modules.

Assessments carried out during the year with marks being returned to students for the taught modules. All marks are provisional and are only finalised at the Board of Examiners.

The pass mark for all taught modules is 50%. Students are normally permitted one further attempt to pass a failed module with the mark used in calculating the final award capped at 50%.

Students who, at the first attempt, have failed taught modules to the value of more than 40 CATS points, or who have failed the same module twice, will be called to a Student Support Meeting (see link below for further information):

http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/StudentGuidance/StudentSupportMeetings-AStudentGuide/

9.1 Assessment Support Hub

The University's Assessment Support Hub provides you with a range of information to support you with your assessment at Queen's. This includes sources of support to help you prepare for assessment the relevant procedures if you require adjustments or mitigations for assessments, such as the Exceptional Circumstances Procedure.

http://go.qub.ac.uk/ASF-Toolkit

9.2 Fit to Sit Policy

The University operates a Fit to Sit Policy. This means that it is your responsibility to ensure that you undertake assessments only if you are fit to do so. By submitting or attempting an assessment, you are confirming that there is no reason why your performance would be adversely impacted or why you might subsequently bring forward a request for exceptional circumstances.

The decision on whether to attempt the assessment, and the consequences of that decision, is your responsibility.

If you are unable to complete your assessment as expected, the *Adjustments and Mitigations section of the Assessment Support Hub* provides information on what you may be eligible for and how to apply.

9.3 Late submission of Assessed Work

Assessed work submitted after the relevant deadline will be penalised in accordance with the Regulations. Exemptions may be granted only if there are Exceptional Circumstances, as defined by the Regulations, and where the student has appropriately notified the School Office (see below).

9.4 Exceptional Circumstances

Exceptional circumstances are defined as unforeseen factors or factors outside the student's control (such as illness) which may adversely affect performance. It is the responsibility of students to ensure that an Exceptional Circumstances form along with any medical certificates and/or other evidence are submitted within three days of returning to their studies or, in the case of emergencies which arose during examinations, within three days from the date of their last examination. The Exceptional Circumstances Form can be completed online at Exceptional Circumstances Application · Queen's Portal. The circumstances will be considered by an Exceptional Circumstances Committee, which will subsequently make a recommendation to the Board of Examiners as to the concession that should be applied. Boards of Examiners are not obliged to consider any medical certificate or evidence of extenuating circumstances presented more than three days after the last examination.

9.5 Plagiarism

Reports and assignments which form part of a module assessment must be the student's own work. The University has strict regulations on copying and plagiarism, and severe penalties may be imposed. Coursework (including project reports and dissertation) submitted as part of your MSc may be subjected to an originality check.

Plagiarised material will be deemed to be passages from other works (or a paraphrase of such) incorporated without acknowledgement and with the intention of it being taken to be the candidate's own work. This includes auto-plagiarism (to use excerpts from his or her previous work without appropriate acknowledgement) and self-plagiarism (to submit one piece of work more than once, e.g. where such has been previously submitted for a different assignment).

Students must not copy from the work of other students or collude with others to present unauthorised group work as your own. In situations where you worked as part of a group on the practical aspects of a project, you must still produce an individual report unless specifically instructed otherwise by the project supervisor. Marks awarded for group work may be subject to moderation.

It is an academic offence for students to plagiarise. Definitions and procedures for dealing with academic offences can be found in the Regulations.

9.6 Academic Misconduct

In order to safeguard our academic standards and the integrity of our awards the University has procedures in place for dealing with suspected academic misconduct. The procedure details types of academic misconduct, such as

cheating in an examination, plagiarism, collusion and fabrication, how suspected offences are investigated and the penalties that can be imposed. The procedure also details students' rights of appeal in cases relating to academic misconduct.

The Procedures for Dealing with Academic Offences can be found at:
http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/Procedures/ProceduresforDealingwithAcademicOffences/

A Student Guide on the Procedures for Dealing with Academic Offences can be found at:
https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/AppealsComplaintsandMisconduct/AcademicOffences/

9.7 Individual Research Project

The research project is a major component of the MSc programme. Project work will normally commence in the second semester. Once projects have been assigned, students should contact their project supervisor and arrange to start work on the project as soon as possible. Prior to the summer examination period this work will typically focus on background reading and literature research. Following the summer examination period, students are expected to work full-time on the project.

As a postgraduate student, it is your responsibility to plan the conduct of your project, such as background reading, experiments, assessing equipment requirements, setting objectives and writing the dissertation. You should consult with your project supervisor regularly about these matters.

Students must keep a written record of weekly progress and actions agreed at supervisory meetings. The supervisor may inspect this record during the project. Before taking any time off you should consult with your supervisor and make appropriate adjustments to your time plan so that deadlines are met. All absences must be reported to the supervisor.

9.7.1 Assessment of the Project

As a part of your individual research project, you will be required to submit a Dissertation Report (i.e. a final project report, in the form of a research paper). This is worth 70% of the project mark and will contain approximately 5000 words. You will also submit Supporting Materials (worth 30% of the project mark). Supporting Materials should include information describing additional materials for context and literature, information about the project life cycle, information about the tools used in the development process of the project, or supplementary experiments or results not included in the Dissertation Report. Supporting Materials should also include a short explanatory video. Supporting Materials can include a written document, a code repository (e.g. version control tool – GitLab), and interactive code notebooks e.g. Jupyter Notebook. Students are also required to demonstrate their completed project to the supervisor and assessor in an oral session at the end of the project. Further guidelines and assessment criteria will be provided before the commencement of the project. The project report and supporting materials are submitted at the end of the project work. The dissertation report and dissertation supporting materials will be assessed by the Supervisor and a Second Assessor. The MSc External Examiner may also assess the dissertation.

9.8 Progression

The University's Study Regulations set out the rules and procedures that determine your final classification or award, including:

(i) The number of credits required to progress to each level of study.
(ii) Mark scales and pass marks for Undergraduate and Postgraduate programmes.
(iii) How your final degree classification or postgraduate award is calculated.

The University's Study Regulations can be found at:
http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/GeneralRegulations/StudyRegulations/

The Assessment Support Hub provides further information to help you understand credit and degree classifications: After Assessment.

Students can resit failed modules once, with the mark used in calculating the final MSc award capped at 50%.

Students who, at the first attempt, have not achieved satisfactory performance in all specified compulsory elements in modules with a combined value greater than 40 CATS points will normally be required to transfer to the Postgraduate Certificate.

Students who fail the same module twice will normally be required to transfer to the Postgraduate Certificate and may not progress to complete the individual research project.

Normally, students must have satisfactorily completed all required taught modules (120 CATS points) to be permitted to complete the individual research project. In certain circumstances, students who fail one taught module may be permitted to progress to the individual research project, with the agreement of the Course Director and the Advisor of Studies.

The pass mark for the research project is 50%. Students who fail the individual research project will have the opportunity to resubmit capped at 50%. Projects may be assessed by the external examiner, and marks finalised at the board of examiners meeting.

9.9 Awards

Postgraduate Master's awards are made in accordance with the following mark scale:

70+	Pass with distinction *
60+	Pass with commendation
50+	Pass
Below 50	Fail

* For Master's Degrees, a pass with distinction will be awarded only when the following three conditions have been satisfied: an overall average of 70+ is achieved, a mark of 70+ is achieved in the dissertation module, and an average of 65+ is achieved in the other modules.

10.Student feedback

(i) Overview of opportunities

https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/CentreforEducationalDevelopment/LearningTeachingandAssessment/Assessment/AssessmentandFeedback/StudentFeedback/StudentRepresentation/

Mechanisms for providing feedback about programmes, including:

Teaching and module evaluations
http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/CentreforEducationalDevelopment/LearningTeachingandAssessment/LearningandTeaching/ReflectivePracticeforStaff/StudentEvaluationofTeaching/

Internal student surveys and NSS

http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/CentreforEducationalDevelopment/LearningTeachingandAssessment/Assessment/AssessmentandFeedback/StudentFeedback/

(ii) Course Representative(s)

(iii) Student Voice Committees
http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/CentreforEducationalDevelopment/LearningTeachingandAssessment/Assessment/AssessmentandFeedback/StudentFeedback/StudentRepresentation/

(iv) The Queen's Student Partnership Framework and how to get involved in School-level activities:
http://www.qub.ac.uk/sites/studentpartnership/

10.1 Student Representation

The University and the Students' Union are committed to student representation, in order to ensure meaningful student participation in decision-making and collective, routine engagement by students as partners in the quality of their educational experience.

As outlined in the QUB-QUBSU Student Academic Representation Code of Practice, the University and the Students' Union hold a joint commitment to five principles of student academic representation. The purpose of student academic representation is to engage students as equal partners in academic governance. Through student academic representation, students should be members of the decision-making process on issues related to the student learning experience

Every student should have clearly defined peer representation; every student should have the opportunity to become a representative.

Students should be represented at all levels of decision-making on issues that impact the student learning experience and are full members on all decision-making committees, fora and subgroups throughout the University to facilitate effective student input into decision making on the student learning experience. The views of students are given equal consideration to the views of others, and student representatives are adequately supported by the University in developing informed and considered input into decision-making. Students are fully involved in the design and review of curricula, including through quality assurance processes. The Students' Union and the University shall continually review and monitor the programme of academic representation including an annual review to ensure it is in line with best practice and meets the needs and expectations of both staff and students.

Every year, the Students' Union and the University recruit, train and support over eight hundred student volunteers called Academic Representatives to act as advocates for the academic interests of students. This includes leading on educational initiatives within Schools, as well as formal participation in committees at all levels of the University: from School Education Committees, through to central University Committees such as Academic Council, the most senior academic committee and Senate, the governing body. Academic Representatives also participate in joint meetings between students and staff called Student Voice Committees, which take place twice a semester and act as sites of partnership and dialogue.

Students are also represented through quality assurance mechanisms such as the University's procedures for reviewing modules (module review), whole programmes (Continuous Action for Programme Enhancement) and entire subject areas (Periodic School Review Process), that all make provision for student members of review panels.

10.2 Student Evaluation of Teaching

The University requires that every module is reviewed every time it is taught and before it can be taught again. This module review, as it is called, is intended to ensure that any problems with the module are addressed and also

to ensure that good features of the module can be noted and perhaps incorporated into other modules. Feedback from students is a key element in module review and students will normally be expected to complete a teaching evaluation questionnaire towards the end of the module. In addition, student course reps will normally be included in the membership of the module review panel.

If you are a student, then please take the time to complete the questionnaires - feedback is fundamental to maintaining and improving the quality of academic provision. All questionnaires, whether they are completed on paper or online, are anonymous.

Students should be able to find out from School notice boards or course reps what action has been taken in response to their feedback and module handbooks sometimes make reference to changes that have been adopted in response to feedback from previous cohorts of students. It may not be possible or even desirable to respond to every suggestion made by students so taking no action is a legitimate response. However, in these circumstances, students should be told why no action has been taken.

Student Evaluation of Teaching Policy
Procedures for Student Evaluation of Teaching
Core Module Evaluation Questions

10.3 Student Feedback

There are various reasons why the University needs and collects feedback from students. By measuring student satisfaction, it helps us monitor and review the quality of our academic provision and student services, and ultimately improve this quality. Equally important, the University seeks to empower students as active participants in their own learning. This requires students to reflect on their experience of learning and feed back to staff on how this experience could be improved.

Feedback from students is collected in a number of ways including:

- Major student experience surveys such as the National Student Survey and the University's own First and Second Year Experience Surveys
- The systematic student evaluation of teaching which is embedded in the University's quality assurance and enhancement procedures
- Student representation on student-staff consultative committees and University committees and student representation via the Students' Union.

Students may also give feedback more informally and less directly through their participation in lectures and tutorials.

Achieving a dialogue with students which generates constructive feedback relies on ensuring students feel confident that staff are listening to their feedback and using it effectively.

10.4 Student Voice Committee

Early in the year, you may be asked to elect a representative for the Student Voice Committee (SVC). The SVC is charged with providing student input into the course. The SVC enables students to propose modifications to the course where the student body regards these as desirable.

11. Working on-Campus during the Academic Year

We recognise that some students may have to work while completing their degree. There are several good reasons for doing this, as work can help you to:

- Develop valuable employability skills that will impress future employers.
- Gain experience and a greater understanding of the workplace.
- Access and develop networking opportunities.
- Support yourself financially during your studies.

In alignment with sector wide best practice, the University strongly recommends that students devote no more than 15 hours per week with a weekly cap on working on campus at 20 hours per week. There is strong evidence to show that significant levels of work can compromise your academic progress and affect degree outcomes.

If you wish to work for the University, you should register on QWork, the university's management system for casual workers. The advertising and recruitment of casual work opportunities will be carried out via QWork during this academic year.

To register click here

If you require any support with QWork please contact qworkadmin@qub.ac.uk.

Please note that ALL students have a maximum of 20 hours per week restriction for casual work each week. This is managed by QWork and linked to relevant term time dates. You should supply your student number on registration to ensure your hours are not adversely impacted during non-term time dates.

You must not agree or undertake any casual work within the university unless you have been offered and accepted an assignment on QWork. It is your responsibility to submit a weekly timesheet through QWork for processing and to avoid any delay with payment processing.

Student Visa Holders will have further compliance measures within QWork for working in the UK. Queen's University has put measures in place to ensure that all Student Visa Holders can only be commissioned work within their working hours limits.

As a Student Visa Holder, it is your responsibility to ensure that you only undertake hours of work that have been commissioned by your Hiring Manager and accepted by you through QWork. Failure to comply with this process may result in the University withdrawing sponsorship of your visa (which means that you will no longer be permitted to study at the University) and UKVI curtailing your leave to remain.

Further information can be found at:

Working in the UK
Periods of Study, Holidays and Other Absences
QWork QUB Students – Request Variation to Weekly Hours Limit

We do urge you to be sensible about how you manage your study, work and social time to get the best result you can from your degree. If you do have financial pressures that mean you have to work more hours than is advisable, please come and talk to us. Both the Student Income and Finance Department in the Student Guidance Centre and the Students' Union can give you advice on funds that are available to help students in your position. The Learning Development Service http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/sgc/learning/ can also offer advice on time management.

12. Support

The University is dedicated to empowering students with a disability or long-term condition to fully engage in their studies and achieve academic success. While students can access support at any point in their studies, they are encouraged to contact the University's Accessible Learning Support service as soon as possible to discuss options and ensure supports are in place for them.

Students who are awaiting a diagnosis, or those who are unsure about if they are eligible to access support, are also encouraged to contact the team to explore possible adjustments.

Further information on supports for students with a long-term condition or disability can be found at: Student Information | Student Centre | Queen's University Belfast

Students can also attend the daily Student Wellbeing and Accessible Learning drop in on Level 1 of One Elmwood, (11 - 3pm Monday to Friday) to talk with a member of the team.

12.1 Accessible Learning Support

Accessible Learning Support (formerly known as Disability Services located in Student Guidance Centre) assists students with disabilities in arranging study related support. This includes specific learning difficulties such as dyslexia: Accessible Learning Support

disability.office@qub.ac.uk
http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/sgc/disability/

12.2 The Graduate School

The Graduate School offers an intellectual and social hub that connects students across all disciplinesto one another, and to mentors, leaders, and employers within the University and beyond. More information is available at:

https://www.qub.ac.uk/sites/graduateschool/

12.3 One Elmwood

One Elmwood provides support services, including Student Administration (Exams, Records and Graduation), Admissions, the Learning Development Service, Careers Employability and Skills, Disability Services, Counselling Services, the Widening Participation Unit and Student Affairs. The Centre's Information Assistants will help you find the answer to any query about the University.

One Elwood Student Centre | Students | Queen's University Belfast (qub.ac.uk)

12.4 Learning Development Service

The Learning Development Service is available to help you with academic skills. You can have a one- to-one appointment or attend workshops on topics including essay writing, referencing, time management, presentation skills and preparation for exams. You can find out more on their website or by calling into the Student Guidance Centre to make a free appointment.

12.5 Advice SU

Advice SU offers a range of services. More information can be found at the link below:
http://www.qubsu.org/AdviceSU/Academic/

13. Immigration Support Service

The Immigration Support Service provides advice and assistance to international students from applying to the University, right through your studies with Queen's. ISS provides advice in relation to visa and immigration matters including assisting you with any queries you may have. Note that the **EEECS School does not handle visa issues**, and students should contact ISS directly:

http://www.qub.ac.uk/sites/iss/

14. Finance

The University's Student Finance Framework provides a guide on matters relating to tuition fees and associated charges. The Framework also includes a Fee Appeals Process. Note that students **withdrawing** from a module on which they have enrolled are normally required to pay a proportion of fees due. You are strongly advised to read the associated documents, which can be viewed at:

www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/sgc/finance/TuitionFees/

15. What to Do If Things Aren't Going Well

At Queen's we understand that students may encounter times when things are not going well for one reason or another and this can have an impact on their studies. Students are strongly encouraged to contact their School and/or seek support as soon as possible.

Through the Student Wellbeing Service, a wide range of support is available to to equip and empower students to be healthy learners and manage and maintain their mental health and wellbeing. Students can speak to a member of the team and access support for a wide range of issues and concerns including (but not limited to) stress, loneliness, anxiety, academic pressures, bereavement, depression, mental health, transitions, addiction, sleep, relationship concerns, etc.

Support from the team includes:

(i) A daily drop in on Level 1 of One Elmwood (11-3pm Mon – Fri)
(ii) Guided 1:1 support on strategies to manage and maintain mental health and wellbeing
(iii) Safe and healthy relationships support and advice
(iv) Access to free student counselling
(v) Onward referral for specialist voluntary sector or NHS support
(vi) Events and initiatives in collaboration with Queen's Sport, and Mind your Mood project in the Student's Union
(vii) Support to Fully Participate in studies and University life

Further information on supports available through the Student Wellbeing service can be found at: *http://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/sgc/wellbeing/*

Advice and guidance on the following issues are available from SU Advice, located on Level 3 of the Students' Union**.**

Drop-in advice sessions take place every Tuesday, Wednesday, and Friday from 11:30 AM to 2:00 PM. Students may also request appointments outside these hours. For email assistance, contact su.advice@qub.ac.uk.

Academic Support
Academic Appeals
Exceptional Circumstances Procedure
Student Outcome/Support Meetings
Academic Offences Procedures
Fitness to Practise Procedure

Student Conduct
Regulations and Procedures
Appealing a Conduct Committee Decision

Student Complaints
Issues with University Services
Concerns about University Staff
Complaints about Other Students

Financial Advice
Student Finance and Funding
Discretionary University Support Funds
Tuition Fee Liability and Payments
Financial Implications of Course Changes, Suspensions, or Withdrawals
Money Management Support
Social Security Benefits Guidance
Food Bank Referrals
Awareness of Scams, Identity Theft, and Money Laundering

Housing Support
Understanding Tenancy Agreements
Tenancy Deposit Scheme Information
House of Multiple Occupation (HMO) Regulations
Addressing Disrepair Issues
Handling Noise Complaints
Private Tenancy Rights

Students may also obtain academic advice and wellbeing support from their School.

Advice on the Academic Appeal, Academic Offences, Conduct, Fitness to Practise and Student Complaints regulations and procedures is available from the Appeals, Conduct and Complaints Team (*appeals@qub.ac.uk*). Guidance relating to these regulations/procedures can be found at: https://www.qub.ac.uk/directorates/AcademicStudentAffairs/AcademicAffairs/AppealsComplaintsandMisconduct/

16. Student Support and Development Services

Details about service access and offerings are available on-line, and accessible to students on the MyQueen's Website:

https://www.qub.ac.uk/sites/my-queens/

Support students may wish to consider include:

(i) Accommodation
(ii) Anti-bullying and Harassment Policy
(iii) Canvas
(iv) Careers and Employability
(v) Change of address/details
(vi) Chaplaincy
(vii) Childcare
(viii) Counselling
(ix) Degree Plus
(x) Finance
(xi) Health Centre
(xii) Health and Safety
(xiii) International students
(xiv) Languages for Non-Specialists
(xv) Learning Development Service
(xvi) Library
(xvii) Mature and part-time students

(xviii) Personal Development Planning (PDP)
(xix) Postgraduate Centre
(xx) Postgraduate Funding
(xxi) Queen's Sport (PEC)
(xxii) Qsis and Queen's Online (QOL)
(xxiii) Scholarships and Prizes
(xxiv) School support mechanisms
(xxv) Starting University
LDS has developed a Transition Skills for University module to support level 1 students. Delivered online through Canvas, the self-paced module covers the areas of orientation, developing as a student, critical thinking, assessment and support.
(xxvi) Student Computing Centres
(xxvii) Student Guidance Centre
(xxviii) Student Wellbeing
(xxix) Students Intervention Protocol
(xxx) Students with disabilities
(xxxi) Students with Experience of Care
(xxxii) Study Abroad/ERASMUS
(xxxiii) Study support
(xxxiv) Students' Union

Appendix: Timetable

Subject to revision. See announcements for individual modules on Canvas.

Queen's University Belfast

School of Electronics, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science

MSc in Artificial Intelligence
First Semester Timetable 2025/26
Commencing Monday 15th September 2025

Please note week 7 (week commencing 27th October) is a reading week

TIME	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
9 - 10	ECS8052 Knowledge Engineering Prof I Styles CSB/0G/028, Week 1 CSB/01/020 – 9-1, weeks 2-3 DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite) from week 4 onwards	ECS8050 Foundations in AI Dr L Bai CSB/01/020 - Week 1 CSB/01/020 - 9-1 pm - weeks 2-3 DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite) from week 4 onwards		ECS8051 Machine Learning Prof H Wang CSB/01/020 – 9-11 AM, week 1 CSB/0G/028 – 11-1, week 1 CSB/01/020 – 9-11, 1-3 weeks 2-3 DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite) week 4 onwards	
10 - 11					
11 - 12					
12 - 1					
1 - 2					
2 - 3	ECS8052 Knowledge Engineering Prof I Styles CSB/0G/028, Week 1 CSB/0G/028 - 2-3 pm weeks 2-3 DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite) from week 4 onwards	ECS8050 Foundations in AI Dr L Bai CSB/0G/028 – 2-5 pm – week 2 4-6 pm – week 3 DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite) from week 4 onwards		ECS8051 Machine Learning Prof H Wang CSB/0G/028 – 2-5, week 1 CSB/01/020 – 1-3 weeks 2-3 CSB/0G/028 – 3-5, week 2-3 DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite) from week 4 onwards	
3 – 4					
4 - 5					

ASH = Ashby Building; CSB= Computer Science Building, DKB = David Keir Building

Queen's University Belfast

School of Electronics, Electrical Engineering and Computer Science
MSc in Artificial Intelligence
Second Semester Timetable 2025/26
Commencing Monday 5th January 2025

Please note week 22 (week commencing 9th February) is a reading week

TIME	MONDAY	TUESDAY	WEDNESDAY	THURSDAY	FRIDAY
9 - 10		ECS8053 Computer Vision Dr Y Hua DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite)		ECS8054 New Language Processing Dr B Devereux DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite)	ECS8055 AI for Health Dr R Rafiee DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite)
10 - 11					
11 - 12					
12 – 1					
1 - 2					
2 - 3		ECS8053 Computer Vision Dr Y Hua DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite)		ECS8054 New Language Processing Dr B Devereux DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite)	ECS8055 AI for Health Dr R Rafiee DKB/01/333 (Data Analytics Suite)
3 - 4					
4 - 5					